

PROFILE

Engineering leader with 13+ years driving platform transformation at the intersection of distributed systems architecture and cross-functional team leadership. Proven track record designing event-driven, cloud-native solutions on AWS and orchestrating multi-team initiatives that improve reliability, accelerate delivery, and reduce operational costs in regulated healthcare environments. Known for translating complex architectural problems into funded, executable roadmaps — and for building the org-wide practices that outlast any single initiative.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Cross-functional team orchestration
- Event-driven microservices
- Domain-driven design
- SaaS at scale
- Engineering org design
- Technology investment strategy
- FinOps
- Hiring, onboarding & talent development

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

- AWS / Terraform
- DevOps / CI/CD
- Java
- Spring Framework / Spring Boot
- Openshift / Docker
- REST / SOAP
- XML / JSON
- Kafka / ActiveMQ
- Unit + Integration Testing Frameworks
- MongoDB
- Oracle SQL
- HTML/JS/CSS
- Angular / Vue JS
- PCI-DSS
- Fuse / Apache Camel

SENIOR ENGINEERING MANAGER | 2025-PRESENT

Cigna Healthcare Corp.

- Designed and led implementation of an enterprise customer sync to the organization's master data management (MDM) system — replacing a legacy, error-prone batch workflow with an event-driven, self-healing pipeline processing 1–2M records per month in near real-time (down from up to 24-hour batch cycles). The new architecture eliminated the need for constant manual monitoring and reruns, with updates now continuously propagating to dozens of downstream consumers across the enterprise including the customer portal, mobile app, call centers, reporting, and finance.
- Architecting and leading rollout of a three-tier broker contract hierarchy — extending an existing two-tier agency/agent model to support General Agencies with aligned SubFirms, enabling direct commission payouts to writing agents and simplifying commissions processing across 2 General Agencies, 30–40 SubFirms, and thousands of writing agents. Designed traversal strategy to preserve performance of existing parent-child reporting and processes while safely introducing grandparent-grandchild access patterns, coordinating upstream and downstream system partners to remain held-harmless or adopt targeted modifications.
- Directed a cross-functional migration from a legacy monolithic platform to event-driven microservices on AWS — coordinating 4 teams across Architecture, DevOps, Cloud, QA, Product, and Release Management. Improved deployment frequency from monthly releases to on-demand delivery, reduced customer and policy installation latency by 10%, and improved system reliability from 99.5% to 99.9%.
- Led the technical and delivery leadership for a Salesforce integration initiative migrating 3M member records and 15–20M policy records to improve broker relations and call center outcomes — owning the internal integration boundary and enterprise data handoff while partnering with a consulting group on Salesforce-side ingest, transform, and reporting. Expected to increase call center effectiveness 5x by surfacing previously inaccessible member and policy data at point of service.
- Led implementation of a PCI-DSS 4.0-compliant broker-assisted payment platform — scoping cardholder data out of the system boundary through vendor tokenization to eliminate direct storage liability, maintaining a fully auditable event-driven transmission pipeline with DynamoDB-backed audit trails and an Angular-driven broker UX. Executed compliance uplift from PCI-DSS 3.2.1 to 4.0, introducing MFA and strengthened credential controls ahead of the March 2025 enforcement deadline.
- Built and managed an engineering organization of up to 30 engineers and QA professionals across 4 teams — personally interviewing and onboarding dozens of engineers, systems analysts, QA testers, and scrum masters. Designed structured onboarding processes that accelerated time-to-contribution across a complex, domain-rich codebase. Navigated org right-sizing while sustaining delivery continuity across retained and consulting-aligned teams.
- Governed cloud technology investment decisions in partnership with Product, Release Management, and enterprise Architecture — evaluating platform solutions against performance-to-cost benchmarks and conducting post-production cost analysis to optimize the team's delivery footprint.

THURMAN JUSTICE

Senior Engineering Manager

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MANAGER/MENTOR, TECHNOLOGY EARLY CAREER DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM | 2016 - PRESENT

Invested in the development of early-career technologists through Cigna's structured rotation program — involved in hiring, onboarding, and sponsoring participants through internal and external initiatives.

MENTOR, DIVERSITY INVESTMENT VENTURE (DIVE) PROGRAM

Served as a mentor in Cigna's Diversity Investment Venture (DIVE) program — providing career guidance, shadowing opportunities, and technology career coaching to employees in engineering-adjacent roles including IT support and mainframe operations, investing in the broader development of technical talent across the organization.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Central Connecticut State University
Bachelors of Science -
Computer Science
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- Generative AI for Technologists

ENGINEERING MANAGER | 2019 - 2025

Cigna Healthcare Corp.

- Became the first team in the organization to navigate the Enterprise Cloud Center of Excellence (CoE) production readiness evaluation — a rigorous review spanning data governance, security, architecture, compliance, and quality. Subsequently created shared documentation and served as an internal resource, lowering the barrier for all teams that followed.
- Collaborated with enterprise Architecture to develop the organization's initial AWS cloud strategy and best practices, helping establish the standards that governed the broader cloud adoption program.
- Led organizational transition into the SAE Release Train delivery model, preserving team cohesion and throughput during a high-friction structural change while recruiting and onboarding new technical staff aligned to the company's evolving platform vision.
- Spearheaded evaluation and adoption of MongoDB and Kafka to replace legacy relational and point-to-point integration patterns — enabling event-sourced workflows across key domains and establishing the architectural foundation later scaled during the org-wide microservices migration.
- Identified systemic gaps in QA coverage and chartered migration to a fully automated CI/CD model. Currently leading operationalization of a shared configuration and feature toggle management service across cloud and on-premise applications — with leadership endorsement — to enable targeted rollouts, reduce release risk, and move the organization toward full continuous delivery.

SR. SPECIALIST / LEAD APPLICATION DEVELOPER | 2017 - 2019

Cigna Healthcare Corp.

- Spearheaded the ground-up build of the US Individual Market customer and broker portal in Angular, modernizing a legacy CMS-driven frontend into a component-driven, security-hardened application — expanding the platform's partner and line-of-business integration surface to serve a broader national market.
- Architected the initial microservices decomposition strategy for core platform domains, delivering a funded proof-of-concept featuring enhanced OAuth2 authentication, reusable component standards, and automated test coverage — securing leadership investment that seeded the org-wide modernization program.
- Led frontend and backend engineering guilds across multiple teams — driving architecture reviews, defining Angular development standards, and mentoring new hires on practices that improved cross-team code consistency and reduced onboarding ramp time.

APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT SR. SPECIALIST | 2015 - 2017

Cigna Healthcare Corp.

- Served as Product Domain SME for Cigna's core plan and benefit data platform — designing a configuration-driven REST API consumed by internal and external systems, standardizing the XML product schema across lines of business, and building an internal service tracing and reporting domain to extend operational visibility across the portfolio.

APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT SPECIALIST | 2012 - 2015

Cigna Healthcare Corp.

- Designed a configuration-driven UI framework enabling business users to manage product data without engineering intervention — establishing component patterns adopted across the broader portfolio. Integrated an acquired Supplemental Benefit product line via automated ETL workflow and delivered a reporting application supporting the company's core government business services.